

LORRAINE MERCADO

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SUMMARY

Cybersecurity professional with 10+ years of experience managing sensitive data, systems, compliance, and business operations across education, finance, legal, and human resources environments. Hands-on experience securing AWS environments using Terraform, IAM, network segmentation, security monitoring, and automated Infrastructure-as-Code scanning. Skilled in cloud security, incident investigation, identity and access management, vulnerability management, and security automation. Seeking Cloud Security, GRC, or Cybersecurity Analyst opportunities aligning technical controls with business risk and compliance requirements.

SKILLS

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS, Terraform, IAM, VPC, EC2, S3, Systems Manager, CloudWatch, CloudTrail, Athena, ECR

Security & Operations: Cloud Security, Incident Response, Vulnerability Management, Log Analysis, Zero Trust, RBAC, Least Privilege

Tools & Automation: tfsec, Suricata, Sysmon, Burp Suite, Nmap, Nikto, Python, PowerShell, GitHub Actions, Docker

Systems: Linux, Ubuntu, Windows Server, Active Directory, Group Policy

PROJECTS

Secure AWS Infrastructure & DevSecOps Pipeline

2026

- Architected AWS infrastructure with Terraform, including VPC segmentation, security groups, EC2, Systems Manager, and VPC Flow Logs to create a secure and auditable cloud environment.
- Integrated tfsec with GitHub Actions to scan Infrastructure-as-Code on push and block insecure configurations from passing the CI/CD security quality gate.
- Remediated findings involving S3 public access, encryption, versioning, security groups, and CloudWatch logging while applying least privilege and Zero Trust principles.

Cloud Incident Investigation & Response

2026

- Investigated simulated AWS incidents using CloudTrail and Athena to trace suspicious events, identities, source addresses, and affected resources.
- Reconstructed attacker activity from audit logs and documented findings, business risks, containment actions, and remediation recommendations.

Enterprise Active Directory & Identity Management

2026

- Deployed a Windows Server Domain Controller with Active Directory, Organizational Units, and Group Policy; automated user provisioning with PowerShell.
- Applied centralized access controls and integrated Linux endpoints with Active Directory to support enterprise authentication and least-privilege access.

Security Automation & Threat Detection

2026

- Developed Python tools to analyze logs, detect brute-force activity, audit processes, and generate structured security reports.
- Configured Suricata and Sysmon detection rules to identify suspicious network and endpoint activity and support incident investigation.

EXPERIENCE

Innovation Charter School | New York, NY

Oct 2021 – Jul 2024

Systems Administration Manager

- Managed enterprise systems and sensitive personnel data, strengthening data accuracy, access controls, regulatory compliance, and audit readiness.
- Reconciled financial and operational data across multiple platforms and administered secure processes for confidential testing and education records.

SKF Electrical Corp. | New York, NY

Sep 2020 – Dec 2020

Human Resources & Payroll Administrator

- Implemented a paperless records system that reduced data exposure, improved auditability, saved approximately \$120,000 annually, and reduced time-to-hire by 50%.
- Managed sensitive payroll and employee data and supported regulatory audits, documentation, and internal controls.

Moaddel Law Firm | Los Angeles, CA

Feb 2017 – Jul 2018

Executive Assistant

- Supported deployment, configuration, and troubleshooting of servers, desktops, networks, and communication systems across business operations.
- Implemented digital workflows and proprietary systems that improved data management, operational scalability, and information security.

Police Athletic League, Inc. | New York, NY

Jul 2009 – Jun 2015

Human Resources & Payroll Coordinator

- Managed biweekly payroll and sensitive personnel data for 800+ employees while maintaining accuracy, confidentiality, and regulatory compliance.
- Conducted audits and reconciliations and maintained enterprise databases, strengthening financial controls, data quality, and audit readiness.

EDUCATION

The Knowledge House | Bronx, NY

Jan 2026 – Present

Innovation Fellowship – Cybersecurity Track

- Hands-on training in cloud security, network defense, vulnerability management, incident response, security automation, and infrastructure hardening.

Lehman College | Bronx, NY — Bachelor of Arts, Political Science

CERTIFICATIONS

SHRM Senior Certified Professional (SHRM-SCP), 2023 • SHRM Certified Professional (SHRM-CP), 2022